



CAMPAIGN MEASUREMENT

UTM Campaign Naming Template

Build one campaign-tagging system your team can actually follow, then use the same language across channels and reports.

TEMPLATE

UTM naming rarely becomes a problem on day one. It becomes a problem three months later, when one campaign appears under several spellings, a source is called both facebook and Facebook, and nobody is quite sure why the dashboard has five versions of the same promotion.

This template is meant to prevent that. It gives you a simple naming system, a field dictionary, and working tables you can copy into a spreadsheet or campaign intake process.

Google Analytics says campaign parameters are case sensitive and recommends a standardized strategy. When custom campaign parameters are used, Google says to always use `utm_source`, `utm_medium`, and `utm_campaign`; it also supports fields such as `utm_id`, `utm_source_platform`, `utm_term`, and `utm_content`.

1. The core naming rules

- [] Use lowercase values throughout the taxonomy.
- [] Use one spelling for each source and medium. Do not alternate between abbreviations without a reason.
- [] Use a stable campaign name for the same campaign across assets and channels.
- [] Use hyphens to separate words instead of spaces or mixed punctuation.
- [] Reserve `utm_content` for creative or placement differences that you actually plan to analyze.
- [] Use `utm_term` when keyword-level identification is useful and the source supports it.
- [] Keep a shared naming dictionary so different people do not invent new values mid-campaign.

2. Field dictionary

Parameter	What it tells you	Example	Your standard
<code>utm_id</code>	Campaign or promotion ID when a stable ID is useful	spring26-01	
<code>utm_source</code>	Where the traffic came from	google, instagram, newsletter	
<code>utm_medium</code>	The marketing medium or channel type	cpc, paid_social, email	
<code>utm_campaign</code>	The overall campaign name	spring-offer	
<code>utm_source_platform</code>	The platform responsible for directing the traffic	google-ads, meta-ads	
<code>utm_content</code>	Creative, link, or placement variation	video-a, hero-link	
<code>utm_term</code>	Keyword-level value where relevant	roof-repair	

Google notes that `utm_creative_format` and `utm_marketing_tactic` exist as campaign parameters but are not currently reported in Analytics properties. Do not build a reporting workflow that depends on those fields being visible there.

3. Recommended internal format

A practical starting convention is:

utm_source = platform or referrer | utm_medium = channel type | utm_campaign = campaign slug |
utm_content = creative or placement | utm_term = keyword when relevant

Campaign	Source	Medium	Campaign	Content	Term
Spring sale email	newsletter	email	spring-sale	hero-link	
Google search	google	cpc	spring-sale	ad-a	spring-sale-keyword
Instagram paid	instagram	paid_social	spring-sale	video-a	
Partner referral	partner-name	referral	spring-sale	article-link	

4. Campaign intake worksheet

Field	Decision / value
Landing page URL	
Campaign goal	
utm_id	
utm_source	
utm_medium	
utm_campaign	
utm_source_platform	
utm_content	
utm_term	
Owner	
Launch date	

5. Channel dictionary builder

Before you launch, decide how your team will name each recurring source and medium. The goal is not to produce hundreds of rules. The goal is to remove avoidable variation.

Platform / source	utm_source	utm_medium	Notes
Google Ads			
Meta Ads			
LinkedIn			
TikTok			
Email platform			
Organic social			
Partner / referral			
Print / QR			
Other			

6. QA before the link goes live

- [] The final URL reaches the intended landing page.
- [] utm_source, utm_medium, and utm_campaign are present when custom campaign tagging is being used.
- [] Values match the team's naming dictionary exactly, including capitalization.
- [] No spaces or accidental punctuation have been introduced by the campaign-building process.
- [] The campaign name is recognizable to someone looking at a report six months later.
- [] utm_content is different only when the difference is meaningful enough to analyze.
- [] The URL has been tested in the real environment, not only checked visually.

7. Finished URL examples

https://example.com/?utm_source=google&utm_medium=cpc&utm_campaign=spring-sale

https://example.com/?utm_source=newsletter&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=spring-sale&utm_content=hero-link

https://example.com/?utm_source=instagram&utm_medium=paid_social&utm_campaign=spring-sale&utm_content=video-a

Remember: UTM values are not decoration. They become reporting dimensions. A naming mistake made in the campaign can become a data-cleanup project later.

8. Governance

- [] One person or role owns the naming dictionary.
- [] Campaign builders have a place to find the approved values before launch.
- [] New source or medium values are added intentionally, not ad hoc.

[] Old campaign names remain documented so historical reports stay understandable.

[] The team periodically reviews the Traffic acquisition report for unexpected variants and '(not set)' patterns.

Reference

Google Analytics: URL builders - Collect campaign data with custom URLs. Current guidance reviewed September 2026. Source: support.google.com/analytics/answer/10917952